

BLACK DRAGONS INITIATIVE -- FOUNDING DOCUMENT

LEVIATHAN RISING: A Declaration of Sovereign Determination

Revised Edition -- 2026-09-11

PUBLISHED 2026-09-11 -- E5 ENCLAVE INC.

PROVENANCE & PUBLICATION NOTE

Provenance & publication note

E5 Enclave Inc. is a nonpartisan 501(c)(3) nonprofit organization. This founding document is preserved as written; provisions directing electoral candidate activity have been struck from this edition with visible markers and dated notes, per the Chairman's ratified amendments to War Room 3 (2026-09-11), and are parked for the affiliated 501(c)(4) sibling upon completion of its registration.

E5 Enclave Inc. does not endorse unlawful conduct. Retained exempt-organizations tax counsel is reviewing this edition; issue-accountability work unrelated to candidates may be reinstated on counsel's advice.

REVISION NOTE - what changed and why

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Authority: Chairman's ratified amendments to War Room 3 (2026-09-11). War-room RED gates G2 ("support candidates" language) and G5 (the "reparations campaign" wording collision) are resolved here as directed. Supporting recon: `~/workspace/recon/war\_room\_3\_thread\_legal.md`, `~/workspace/recon/war\_room\_3\_thread\_adgrants.md`, `~/workspace/recon/war\_room\_3\_thread\_political\_activity.md` (the 30% political-activity figure is corrected there: campaign intervention is absolutely prohibited for 501(c)(3)s - zero safe number; lobbying is capped by the 501(h) dollar formula, never 30%).

Change 1 - Electoral / candidate activity **STRUCK** (G2, Chairman amendment 2)

All provisions directing electoral candidate activity are struck from this 501(c)(3)-hosted edition and **parked for the affiliated 501(c)(4) sibling** (the forthcoming Black Lives Matter Miami 501(c)(4) registration). They move there upon completion of that registration. The campaign container conducts no electoral activity.

Struck in this draft (marked `[STRUCK 2026-09-11]` inline): 1. The entire **"Electoral Strategy" subsection** (strategic electoral offices, elected-official accountability mechanisms, independent political organizations, candidate development pipelines, policy institutes) - struck in full. Issue-accountability work unrelated to candidates may be reinstated on counsel's advice. 2. Call to Action: "Engage in electoral campaigns for candidates committed to community control." 3. Call to Action: "Mobilize electoral power to advance candidates committed to community control."

Retained (analytical, not operative - flagged for counsel): the strategic-assessment line that "electoral politics is a tactical terrain, not a primary strategy," and descriptive references to voter suppression and corporate money in politics. These describe conditions; they direct no candidate activity.

Companion - Declaration of Self-Determination strike schedule (to be applied when the Declaration draft is produced): - D1. "We will hold officials accountable **and run our own candidates - nurturing a new generation of Black leaders who serve the people, not entrenched interests.**" -> strike the bolded clause; keep "We will hold officials accountable." - D2. Pledge bullet "Build Political Power in Our Communities": strike **"Run for office or support candidates who are accountable to the Black community."** Keep the remainder of the bullet (assemblies, voter drives, advocacy groups, lobbying for policies, presence at school boards/councils/legislatures).

Change 2 - "Reparations" reframed as the debt owed, claimed to exit and establish (G5, Chairman amendment 3)

The word "reparations" is struck from the Manifesto as presented. Pillar 2 is reframed per the Chairman's direction: **the debt owed, to be used to exit and establish** - the separatist economic-independence mindset (claimed as material basis for withdrawing our economic life from extractive systems and building independent Black institutions: land, enterprise, and infrastructure held outright). No figures added (the no-settlement-number rule stands). The verify-sovereign ban on the phrase "reparations campaign" is honored - the phrase appears nowhere in this draft.

Reframed passages: - Pillar heading: "Securing Economic Justice and Reparations" -> "Securing Economic Justice and the Debt Owed" - "Reparations Campaign - Advance comprehensive reparations demands..." -> "The Debt Owed - Claimed to Exit and Establish - Advance the comprehensive claim for the debt owed... as the material basis for exit and establishment..." - Pathways clause now directs all recovered resources "toward exit and establishment, never toward integration into the systems that extracted them" - "coalitions... supporting reparations" -> "coalitions... supporting the debt-owed claim" - "educational resources... basis for reparations" -> "...basis for the debt owed" - "reparations are necessary but insufficient" -> "the debt owed is necessary but insufficient" - Pillar summary list and contemporary-movements references updated identically.

Standing constraints carried into this draft

The Leviathan, described in ancient texts as a creature of unmatched power and fearlessness, embodies our movement's essence. Just as its name etymologically means "to couple, connect, or join," we represent the coupling of diverse individuals into an unstoppable collective force. We are many, yet we move as one - our individual strengths magnified through unity of purpose, strategy, and action. This manifesto serves as both a declaration of our vision and a detailed blueprint for action. It articulates our understanding of the historical conditions that necessitate our existence, defines our core principles, outlines our strategic objectives, and issues a call to action for all who recognize that Black liberation is essential not only for Black people but for the creation of a truly just society. We stand firmly in the lineage of those who fought before us, from the maroon communities who created autonomous zones of

freedom within systems of enslavement, to the Black Power advocates who insisted on self-determination, to the contemporary movements asserting that Black lives matter. We honor their wisdom while advancing new strategies appropriate for our time. The Black Dragons Initiative is not merely an organization but a movement - a Leviathan of the people, by the people, and for the people. We are the embodiment of collective power directed toward sovereign determination. We rise not as supplicants asking for concessions, but as a people claiming our inherent right to determine our destiny. Like the Leviathan, we make no pacts with oppression; we emerge to transform the fundamental conditions of our existence.

I. FOUNDATIONAL PRINCIPLES

Our movement stands upon four interconnected principles that guide our vision, analysis, and action. These principles are nonnegotiable foundations upon which we build our strategic framework:

Political Independence

We affirm the right of Black people to self-governance and political autonomy. Political independence means having definitive control over the institutions, policies, and decisions that affect our communities. We reject the hollow victories of token representation within systems designed to perpetuate our subjugation. True political independence requires the development of independent Black political power - the capacity to elect representatives accountable to our communities, to form autonomous governing institutions where necessary, and to exercise veto power over policies that harm our people. As Malcolm X declared, "the political philosophy of Black nationalism means that the Black man should control the politics and the politicians in his own community." This principle demands that we build political consciousness, cultivate leadership from within our communities, develop alternative governance structures where existing ones fail us, and strategically engage with formal political systems to advance our interests. We measure political independence not by symbolic victories but by concrete shifts in decision-making power and accountability.

Economic Self-Sufficiency

We recognize that political power without economic power is illusory. Economic self-sufficiency means developing systems of production, distribution, and exchange that serve Black communities and remain under Black control. It requires building institutions that circulate resources within our communities rather than extracting them. Economic self-sufficiency encompasses: Community ownership of vital resources and enterprises

Cooperative economic models that distribute wealth equitably Development of Black financial institutions that deploy capital according to our priorities

Land and housing controlled by and for Black communities Skillsets and technologies that enable autonomous production of necessities

Our economic strategy prioritizes collective advancement over individual success, understanding that in a context of systematic exploitation, individual prosperity for a few never equals liberation for all.

Cultural Renaissance

We affirm the essential role of cultural consciousness in liberation. For centuries, systems of oppression have attempted to separate us from our histories, languages, spiritual traditions, and ways of knowing. A comprehensive cultural renaissance is necessary to heal these wounds and forge a liberated future. Cultural renaissance involves: Reclaiming and honoring our diverse African and diasporic traditions

Creating educational systems that center Black histories and perspectives

Developing arts, media, and cultural production that articulate our experiences and visions Restoring indigenous African spiritual practices while respecting religious diversity Fostering intergenerational knowledge transfer and community wisdom

This principle recognizes that decolonizing the mind is inseparable from liberating the material conditions of Black life. Our cultural renaissance defuses the cultural bomb that sought to annihilate our belief in our names, languages, environment, heritage of struggle, unity, capacities, and ultimately ourselves.

Radical Solidarity

We understand that our liberation is bound with the liberation of all oppressed peoples. Radical solidarity means recognizing our connected struggles and building alliances based on mutual respect, shared objectives, and reciprocal support. It means rejecting the divide-and-conquer tactics that have historically been used to prevent unified resistance. Radical solidarity encompasses: Pan-African unity across the global African diaspora

Principled alliances with Indigenous peoples, whose land sovereignty struggles parallel our own
Solidarity with all communities fighting against white supremacy and colonialism

Coalitions with working-class movements confronting economic exploitation
Support for liberation struggles worldwide against imperialism and oppression

This principle rejects narrow nationalism that ignores the interconnected nature of global systems of domination. As Audre Lorde stated, "There is no such thing as a single-issue struggle because we do not live single-issue lives." Our solidarity is not symbolic but strategic - recognizing that our collective power grows through unified action while respecting the autonomy of different struggles. These four principles - Political Independence, Economic Self-Sufficiency, Cultural Renaissance, and Radical Solidarity - constitute the philosophical foundation of the Black Dragons Initiative. They are not abstract ideals but practical guides for our strategic work. They reinforce one another, creating a comprehensive framework for liberation that addresses the full spectrum of our people's needs and aspirations.

II. HISTORICAL FOUNDATIONS & CONTEMPORARY CONTEXT

The Legacy of Resistance Our struggle did not begin today. We stand in a lineage of resistance that extends back to the first moments of African captivity in the Americas. Understanding this history is essential to comprehending our present condition and charting our future course. From the beginning, African peoples resisted enslavement

through numerous means: armed rebellion, escape, sabotage, cultural preservation, and the creation of alternative communities. Maroon societies - communities of escaped enslaved people who established autonomous zones throughout the Americas - represent early experiments in Black self-determination. These communities developed independent governance, economic systems, and defensive capabilities while maintaining African cultural practices. They demonstrate that Black sovereignty is not a new concept but a persistent aspiration.

The Haitian Revolution (1791-1804) marked history's most successful slave rebellion, establishing the world's first Black republic and dealing a decisive blow to the ideology of white supremacy. Haiti's example showed that complete liberation was possible through organized resistance. As Toussaint Louverture declared, "I was born a slave, but nature gave me the soul of a free man." Throughout the 19th and 20th centuries, Black liberation movements took various forms: abolition campaigns, civil rights organizing, Pan-African congresses, Black nationalist formations, and revolutionary socialist movements. Each contributed valuable lessons to our understanding of struggle: The Garvey Movement demonstrated the power of mass organization and economic self-determination, building the Universal Negro Improvement Association with millions of members worldwide and establishing Black-owned businesses and shipping lines. Marcus Garvey understood that "a people without the knowledge of their past history, origin and culture is like a tree without roots." The Civil Rights Movement secured important legal victories against segregation through strategic nonviolent direct action, moral witness, and international pressure. It revealed both the possibilities and limitations of reform within existing systems. Martin Luther King Jr.'s evolution toward questioning capitalism and imperialism in his later years reflected a growing understanding that civil rights without economic justice remained incomplete. The Black Power Movement advanced self-determination and community control, establishing independent political organizations, educational institutions, and self-defense groups. The Black Panther Party's Ten-Point Program articulated a comprehensive vision of liberation addressing political power, economic justice, housing, education, justice system reform, and peace. Their community survival programs - free breakfast initiatives, health clinics, schools - demonstrated how to build alternative institutions within hostile environments.

Within our own communities, visionaries like Ralph McCartney of

Overtown, Miami exemplified the power of dedicated local action. Working tirelessly behind the scenes with elected officials, McCartney secured the construction of the Edison Park Elementary I-95 Overpass, ensuring children could safely access education without risking their lives crossing a dangerous interstate highway. His efforts to preserve and rebuild the historic Booker T. Washington School demonstrated his understanding that educational institutions are central to community sovereignty. McCartney's legacy reminds us that liberation requires both public protest and the patient, persistent work of building and protecting community infrastructure. Revolutionary Black thinkers like W.E.B. Du Bois, C.L.R. James, Claudia Jones, Walter Rodney, Frantz Fanon, and Angela Davis developed

theoretical frameworks connecting our struggle to global anti-colonial and anti-capitalist movements. They understood that Black liberation required confronting intersecting systems of domination including white supremacy, capitalism, imperialism, and patriarchy. These ancestors provide us with a rich tapestry of strategic wisdom, theoretical insight, and practical experience. We honor their sacrifices by learning from both their victories and their setbacks, adapting their lessons to our contemporary context.

Contemporary Conditions and Contradictions

Today, despite formal legal equality and the visibility of individual Black success stories, the fundamental conditions of Black life in America and globally continue to reflect structural oppression: The wealth gap between Black and white Americans remains extreme, with median white household wealth approximately ten times that of median Black household wealth. This disparity results directly from historical theft and ongoing discrimination - from slavery and Jim Crow to redlining, predatory lending, wage discrimination, and unequal access to capital. Mass incarceration functions as a system of racial control, with Black Americans incarcerated at more than five times the rate of whites. The prison-industrial complex extracts labor, wealth, and political power from Black communities while generating profit for private corporations and rural white economies dependent on prison jobs. Environmental racism concentrates toxic facilities, contaminated

water, food deserts, and climate vulnerability in Black neighborhoods, creating disproportionate health impacts from cancer to asthma to maternal mortality. These conditions reflect

the systemic devaluation of Black lives. Political disenfranchisement through gerrymandering, voter suppression, felony disenfranchisement, and the influence of corporate money in politics undermines Black electoral power. Even when Black officials are elected, their ability to enact transformative policies is constrained by economic power structures and institutional limitations. Cultural appropriation and misrepresentation in media continue while Black cultural producers often lack ownership of distribution channels and production infrastructure. The commodification of Black culture without corresponding economic benefit to Black communities represents ongoing extraction. State violence through police killings, surveillance, and militarized

responses to protest demonstrates the continuity of anti-Black repression despite superficial reforms. The criminalization of Black resistance contrasts sharply with the tolerance shown to white supremacist organizing and violence. Gentrification and displacement destroy historic Black neighborhoods and cultural centers, dispersing communities and erasing accumulated social capital. This process transfers land and property from Black communities to predominantly white investors and newcomers, reproducing historical patterns of dispossession. Global anti-Blackness manifests through immigration policies, labor exploitation, and resource extraction that disproportionately harm African and diasporic populations worldwide. Western powers and multinational corporations continue to undermine African sovereignty through debt, military intervention, and resource control.

These conditions persist not because of lack of effort or inadequate moral appeals but because they serve systemic interests. Symbolic victories and incremental reforms have not - and cannot - address the fundamental structures that reproduce Black oppression. As Kwame Ture observed, "In order for nonviolence to work, your opponent must have a conscience. The United States has none." Contemporary Black resistance movements have responded to these conditions with renewed militancy and strategic innovation. From #BlackLivesMatter to prison abolition organizing, from campaigns for the debt owed to community land trusts, Black communities continue to develop tactics appropriate to current challenges. Digital organizing has created new possibilities for rapid mobilization and narrative intervention. The groundswell of

protest following George Floyd's murder demonstrated the latent power of mass Black-led multiracial resistance.

Yet these movements face significant challenges: state repression, co-optation, internal divisions, resource limitations, and the difficulty of sustaining momentum beyond moments of crisis. The Black Dragons Initiative emerges in this context, drawing lessons from both historical and contemporary movements to develop a comprehensive strategy for sustainable liberation. We recognize that conditions have changed since previous eras of struggle, requiring new approaches: Digital technologies create both surveillance vulnerabilities and organizing opportunities Climate crisis intensifies environmental injustice while creating openings for transformative demands

Economic restructuring has decimated traditional industrial jobs while opening new sectors Demographic shifts alter potential coalition possibilities and electoral calculations Global capital mobility requires transnational resistance strategies Our analysis of historical foundations and contemporary conditions leads to several strategic conclusions: 1. Reforms alone cannot achieve liberation; we must build alternative institutions and paradigms

2. Electoral politics is a tactical terrain, not a primary strategy for transformation 3. Economic power is fundamental to political and cultural sovereignty 4. Sustainable movement-building requires addressing immediate needs while pursuing long-term vision

5. Our strategy must operate across multiple scales: local, regional, national, and international

With this understanding, we now present our strategic framework for Black liberation.

III. STRATEGIC FRAMEWORK FOR LIBERATION

The Black Dragons Initiative advances a comprehensive five-pillar

strategy for achieving sovereign determination. These pillars are not sequential steps but simultaneous lines of effort that reinforce

each other. Like the joined scales of Leviathan, they create an

integrated approach to building power and securing liberation.

1. Building Institutional Autonomy

We will create, strengthen, and connect independent Black institutions that meet our communities' needs outside of or parallel to existing systems. These institutions will embody our values, serve our interests, and remain accountable to our communities. Education and Knowledge Production Establish and expand independent educational institutions from preschool through adult education Develop curriculum that centers Black history, culture, and critical analysis of power systems

Create research institutes that produce knowledge serving Black liberation rather than academic careerism

Train educators in liberatory pedagogies that foster critical consciousness and practical skills Build digital learning platforms and resource libraries accessible to all community members Economic Institutions Develop cooperative businesses owned by workers and community members

Create community development financial institutions (CDFIs) to provide capital on our terms Establish time banks and mutual aid networks that reduce dependency on exploitative markets Build maker spaces and technology centers that develop practical production capabilities

Form purchasing cooperatives to leverage collective buying power Health and Wellness Systems Create community health centers practicing holistic care integrating multiple healing traditions

Train community health workers from our neighborhoods to provide preventative education and support
Develop mental health resources that address historical and ongoing trauma Establish food sovereignty initiatives through urban farms, community gardens, and buying clubs

Build fitness and recreational spaces that promote physical

well-being and community connection Media and Communications Infrastructure Launch independent media platforms across multiple formats: digital, print, radio, and video

Train community journalists and media producers in technical skills and critical analysis Develop secure communications systems resistant to surveillance and disruption

Create archives preserving community history and movement knowledge Build distribution networks ensuring our narratives reach intended audiences Community Safety and Justice Systems Establish community safety teams trained in de-escalation and mediation Develop transformative justice processes addressing harm without relying on police or prisons Create rapid response networks supporting community members facing state violence

Train legal observers and know-your-rights educators to protect against rights violations

Build community bail funds and legal defense resources for those targeted by state repression These autonomous institutions will serve multiple functions: meeting immediate community needs, developing skills and leadership, demonstrating alternative models, and creating infrastructure for greater sovereignty. They will operate according to principles of: Community control and democratic governance Sustainability and ecological responsibility

Accessibility regardless of economic means

Cultural relevance and respect for diversity within our communities

Intentional development of young leadership Building institutional autonomy requires substantial resources, expertise, and coordination. We will approach this work strategically, prioritizing institutions that address critical needs, build on existing community strengths, and create platforms for further development. We recognize that autonomy exists on a spectrum - some institutions may operate completely independently while others may leverage resources from existing systems while maintaining community accountability.

2. Securing Economic Justice and the Debt Owed

Economic justice is fundamental to sovereign determination. We will build economic power through multiple, complementary strategies

targeting both immediate material conditions and longterm structural transformation.

The Debt Owed - Claimed to Exit and Establish

Advance the comprehensive claim for the debt owed - centuries of theft and exploitation - as the material basis for exit and establishment: withdrawing our economic life from extractive systems and building independent Black institutions - land, enterprise, and infrastructure held outright.

Pursue multiple pathways: federal legislation, state and local initiatives, institutional redress, and direct claims - directing all recovered resources toward exit and establishment, never toward integration into the systems that extracted them Develop detailed accounting of historical harms and corresponding remedies

Build coalitions with allied groups supporting the debt-owed claim while maintaining Black leadership

Create educational resources explaining the historical, moral, and legal basis for the debt owed Cooperative Economics Development Establish an incubator for cooperative enterprises providing technical assistance and startup capital Create a revolving loan fund supporting Black-owned businesses that meet community needs

Develop a cooperative federation connecting individual enterprises for mutual support and resource sharing Launch sector-specific initiatives in areas of strategic importance: food, housing, healthcare, technology

Build worker-owned platforms challenging exploitative gig economy models Land and Housing Sovereignty Create community land trusts removing land from the speculative market permanently

Develop limited-equity housing cooperatives providing affordable, democratically controlled housing

Establish a land acquisition fund targeting properties of historical or strategic importance

Support urban and rural farming initiatives building food sovereignty

Provide legal support against displacement, eviction, and predatory lending

Capital Formation and Financial Infrastructure

Establish a Black-controlled investment fund deploying capital according to community priorities

Develop mutual aid networks and cost-sharing associations reducing dependency on exploitative systems

Create alternative currency and exchange systems that keep resources circulating within our communities

Build financial education programs addressing historical exclusion from economic knowledge

Launch collective purchasing initiatives leveraging community economic power Just Transition and Environmental Justice Develop green enterprises creating jobs while addressing environmental harms in our communities Build resilience hubs preparing for climate impacts that disproportionately affect Black neighborhoods Create workforce development programs in renewable energy, green construction, and ecological restoration

Support Black farmers practicing regenerative agriculture and land stewardship Establish environmental monitoring systems documenting and challenging ecological racism

Our economic strategy recognizes that the debt owed is necessary but insufficient - we must simultaneously build new economic models while securing resources stolen over generations. We reject both the exploitation of capitalism and the bureaucratic control of state socialism, instead pursuing economic democracy through community ownership and control. We measure economic success not by individual wealth accumulation but by how well our economic institutions meet collective needs, distribute benefits equitably, and sustain both people and planet.

3. Reclaiming Land and Resources

Land is the physical foundation of sovereignty. Control over territory and resources enables self-determination in concrete rather than abstract terms. We will pursue multiple strategies to reclaim, defend, and steward land and resources for our communities. Strategic Land Acquisition Identify and acquire properties of historical, cultural, or strategic significance

Establish legal structures protecting community ownership in perpetuity

Target abandoned properties, tax-foreclosed land, and other opportunities for reclamation Develop renovation and construction capabilities to improve acquired properties

Create community planning processes determining best uses for reclaimed land Urban Land Reclamation Transform vacant lots into productive community spaces through urban agriculture

Establish neighborhood commons for gathering, recreation, and cultural activities Develop community-controlled commercial spaces supporting local enterprises

Create land-based healing spaces incorporating gardens, art, and ceremonial grounds Build housing under community control through various models: cooperatives, land trusts, mutual housing Rural Land Initiatives Support Black farmers and land stewards maintaining agricultural traditions

Establish agricultural training programs connecting youth with land-based knowledge Develop eco-villages demonstrating sustainable, community-centered living

Create retreat and healing spaces connecting urban communities with rural land

Build regional food systems linking urban and rural initiatives Resource Sovereignty Develop renewable energy cooperatives reducing dependency on extractive utilities

Create water collection, purification, and management systems under community control Establish seed libraries and plant nurseries preserving agricultural biodiversity

Build material reuse and recycling initiatives capturing value from discarded resources Create technology centers developing appropriate tools for community needs Defending Against Displacement

Provide legal defense against eminent domain, tax foreclosure, and predatory lending Develop community organizing strategies against gentrification and predatory development

Create early warning systems identifying properties vulnerable to speculation

Build rapid response capabilities when community members face eviction or displacement Document historical Black presence in neighborhoods to support cultural preservation claims

Our land reclamation strategy recognizes that sovereignty requires a territorial base. We approach this understanding the complex history of land in what is now the United States - acknowledging both the prior sovereignty of Indigenous nations and our own historical relationship to this soil, which we worked and improved through generations of forced and exploited labor. We seek dialogue with Indigenous nations about our shared and distinct relationships to land, working toward models of coexistence that reject colonial paradigms of exclusive ownership.

4. Establishing Community-Controlled Governance

Self-determination requires governance structures accountable to our

communities rather than external interests. We will build and strengthen democratic institutions through which we exercise collective decision-making power.

Neighborhood Councils and Assemblies

Establish democratic neighborhood assemblies making decisions about local priorities

Develop governance models combining direct participation with representative structures Create participatory budgeting processes determining resource allocation

Build capacity for conflict resolution and consensus-building within communities Design accessible meeting formats ensuring broad participation regardless of work schedules, disability, etc. Community Control of Institutions Organize for community control of police, replacing occupying forces with accountable safety systems

Demand community governance of schools, ensuring education serves our children's needs

Establish oversight over environmental regulations and enforcement in our neighborhoods

Create community boards with real power over development, housing, and land use Build resident management of public and affordable housing developments Parallel Governance Structures Develop community courts and justice systems addressing harm through restoration rather than punishment

Create deliberative processes for addressing complex issues facing our communities

Establish conflict resolution mechanisms reducing reliance on hostile state systems Build community planning bodies developing comprehensive visions for neighborhood development Form councils of elders honoring wisdom while engaging youth leadership

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~~Identify strategic electoral offices having direct impact on community conditions~~

~~Develop accountability mechanisms ensuring elected officials serve community interests~~

~~Build independent political organizations distinct from Democratic and Republican parties~~

~~Create candidate development pipelines training community members for governance roles~~

~~Establish policy institutes developing platform positions reflecting community priorities~~

Create digital archives maintaining institutional memory and decision records Develop transparency tools tracking resource flows and decision implementation

Establish communication systems connecting governance bodies with constituents Design accessible interfaces ensuring digital tools don't create new exclusions

Our governance strategy operates on multiple levels, from hyperlocal neighborhood assemblies to citywide coordinating

bodies to regional alliances. We recognize that governance encompasses both formal institutions with legal authority and informal structures of community decision-making. Our goal is to exercise increasing levels of self-determination, recognizing that full sovereignty may involve different forms in different contexts - from community control within existing municipal structures to potential models of autonomy similar to tribal nations or territories.

5. Forging Pan-African Unity and Global Alliances

Our liberation is linked with Black and oppressed peoples worldwide. We will build relationships of solidarity and mutual support across

national boundaries, recognizing that the systems we confront operate globally and require coordinated resistance. Pan-African Connections Establish direct relationships with movements and communities throughout the African diaspora

Create exchange programs enabling shared learning and strategy development Build economic relationships supporting autonomous development across the diaspora

Develop cultural initiatives strengthening connections to African and diasporic traditions

Coordinate political actions around shared concerns affecting Black communities globally Indigenous Solidarity Build respectful relationships with Indigenous nations whose land sovereignty struggles parallel our own Develop protocols for engagement acknowledging the unique histories and legal statuses of our communities Create mutual support mechanisms for land defense and cultural preservation

Learn from Indigenous governance models demonstrating alternatives to colonial structures

Establish concrete solidarity actions supporting Indigenous sovereignty struggles Global South Alliances Connect with movements confronting neocolonialism and economic exploitation worldwide Build relationships with communities resisting extraction, militarism, and displacement

Develop joint campaigns targeting transnational corporations and financial institutions Create knowledge exchanges around sustainable development and community resilience

Establish mutual aid networks responding to humanitarian crises and natural disasters
Worker and Migrant Solidarity Support labor organizing connecting Black workers with broader working-class movements
Build relationships with migrant justice organizations confronting border imperialism

Develop campaigns addressing exploitation in industries employing both Black and immigrant workers

Create spaces for dialogue addressing divisions fostered by ruling interests
Establish concrete support for workers and migrants facing state repression
International Advocacy Engage with United Nations mechanisms addressing racial discrimination and Indigenous rights

Utilize international legal frameworks supporting self-determination and collective rights

Build relationships with sympathetic governments supporting liberation movements

Create alternative diplomatic channels independent of hostile state structures

Develop media strategies bringing international attention to domestic human rights violations

Our international strategy recognizes that borders are colonial constructions and that our liberation movements must transcend them. We draw inspiration from historical internationalism while developing approaches appropriate to contemporary conditions. Our solidarity is not abstract but concrete - expressed through material support, coordinated campaigns, knowledge exchange, and mutual defense. We reject both narrow nationalism that ignores our global connections and uncritical internationalism that erases the specific conditions of Black oppression. These five strategic pillars - Building Institutional Autonomy, Securing Economic Justice and the Debt Owed, Reclaiming Land and Resources, Establishing Community-Controlled Governance, and Forging Pan-African Unity and Global Alliances - provide a comprehensive framework for building Black sovereign

determination. Like the interconnected scales of Leviathan, they reinforce each other, creating a holistic approach to liberation that addresses political, economic, cultural, and international dimensions of our struggle.

IV. ORGANIZATIONAL STRUCTURE AND DIGITAL STRATEGY

The power of our movement depends not only on what we do but how we organize ourselves. The Black Dragons Initiative combines decentralized, grassroots power with strategic coordination, creating a structure that is both resilient against repression and capable of unified action.

Membership and Participation Structure

The Initiative operates with a tiered engagement model, recognizing that people contribute according to their capacity, commitment, and skills: General Membership Open to all Black individuals who affirm our principles and commit to working toward our objectives. General members participate in local chapters, contribute resources according to ability, receive communications, and have voting rights on designated matters. Membership involves both rights and responsibilities, including adherence to our code of conduct and participation in political education. Active Cadre Members who demonstrate consistent commitment and complete advanced training may join working groups focused on specific aspects of our strategy. Cadre members take on organizational responsibilities, implement programs, and participate in strategic planning processes. The cadre model draws from both African village council traditions and modern revolutionary organizations, creating a core of dedicated, highly trained members who ensure continuity and effectiveness. Leadership Bodies Leadership emerges through demonstrated commitment, acquired skills, and democratic selection rather than self-promotion. Our structure includes: Local Chapter Councils: Elected by chapter members to coordinate local activities

Regional Coordinating Committees: Connecting chapters within geographic regions National Council: Composed of regional representatives and members elected at-large Elder Circle: Comprising respected community elders providing wisdom and historical perspective

Youth Congress: Ensuring young voices inform all levels of decision-making This structure balances representation from geographic regions, demographic groups, and strategic sectors. Leadership positions rotate regularly, preventing entrenchment while developing new leaders. All leaders remain accountable through regular reporting, recall provisions, and direct democratic mechanisms.

Decision-Making Processes

We practice democratic centralism adapted to our context: thorough debate and discussion during decision-making, followed by unified implementation once decisions are made. This approach ensures both democratic participation and disciplined action. Key features include: Consensus-seeking for major strategic decisions, with voting mechanisms when consensus cannot be reached Subsidiarity principle: decisions made at the most local level appropriate to the issue Transparency in deliberations and clear communication of rationale for decisions Regular evaluation and willingness to revise approaches based on practical results

Conflict resolution processes addressing disagreements through principled dialogue These processes enable us to make decisions democratically while maintaining the capacity for rapid, coordinated action when circumstances require it.

Chapter Structure and Development

Local chapters form the foundation of our movement, rooted in specific geographic communities. Chapters: Implement the strategic framework according to local conditions and priorities

Recruit and develop new members through community engagement

Build coalitions with local organizations working on aligned issues Develop and manage local resources, including physical spaces where possible Participate in regional and national coordination while maintaining autonomy New chapters develop through a structured process: 1. Study circles formed by community members engaging with our principles and strategies 2. Organizing committees established once study circles are ready for public action 3. Provisional chapter status granted after meeting baseline membership and activity criteria 4. Full chapter recognition following demonstration of sustainable organizing capacity

This developmental approach ensures that chapters are built on solid foundations rather than prematurely formalized. Established chapters mentor emerging ones, sharing lessons and resources.

Internal Education and Development

Continuous political education is essential to building shared analysis and strategic capacity. Our educational system includes: Orientation Program: Introducing new members to our principles, history, and structure

Core Curriculum: Developing understanding of Black liberation theory, organizing skills, and our strategic framework

Advanced Cadre Training: Specialized education for members taking on leadership roles

Skills Development: Practical training in areas relevant to our strategic objectives Leadership Institute: Intensive development for emerging leaders across the organization

Education happens through multiple modalities: in-person sessions, digital learning platforms, mentorship relationships, and self-study with guided reflection. We draw from both academic knowledge and community wisdom, valuing lived experience alongside theoretical understanding.

Security Culture and Resilience

Given historical and ongoing repression of Black liberation movements, we implement security practices protecting our

members and work: Risk assessment protocols identifying vulnerabilities specific to different activities
Digital security training and tools appropriate to various security levels
Physical security measures for events, meetings, and community spaces

Legal support networks prepared to assist members targeted by state repression

Communications protocols designating appropriate channels for different types of information
Transparency about legal, above-ground nature of our work while maintaining appropriate boundaries

Our approach is neither paranoid nor naive, but realistic about the challenges facing movements for fundamental change. We build

security consciousness as a collective practice rather than individual responsibility.

Digital Infrastructure and Strategy

Digital technologies are essential tools for modern

movement-building, enabling communication, coordination,

education, and narrative intervention. Our digital strategy includes: Internal Communication Systems
Secure, encrypted platforms for organizational communication

Tiered access ensuring sensitive information reaches appropriate audiences

Redundant systems preventing single points of failure

Regular security audits and updates maintaining protection against surveillance
Accessibility features ensuring digital tools don't create exclusion
External Digital Presence Website presenting our principles, analysis, and programmatic initiatives

Social media accounts engaging broader audiences and intervening in public discourse

Multimedia content communicating our message through various formats
Interactive tools facilitating supporter engagement and mobilization

Digital dashboards tracking progress toward strategic objectives
Narrative and Counter-Narrative Capacity
Rapid response teams addressing misinformation about our movement

Digital storytelling highlighting community victories and lived experiences
Meme and viral content development translating complex ideas into accessible formats
Monitor and analysis capabilities tracking opposition narratives and discourse trends

Strategic amplification of aligned voices expanding our message reach
Technology Development
Software development focused on movement needs not met by commercial platforms

Open-source tools reducing dependency on corporate digital infrastructure

Training programs building technical capacity within our communities

Ethical data practices respecting community privacy and sovereignty

Appropriate technology approaches matching tools to actual needs and resources

Our digital strategy respects the "high-tech/high-touch" principle -

using technology to enhance rather than replace human connection. We recognize both the liberatory potential of digital tools and their limitations, especially considering digital divides affecting our

communities. Our approach prioritizes technological sovereignty -

control over the tools we use rather than dependency on corporate platforms that extract data and constrain political expression.

This organizational and digital framework creates the infrastructure through which our strategic objectives can be realized. It embodies our principles through democratic practice, develops leadership from within our communities, and builds resilience against opposition. Like the Leviathan's interconnected scales, our organizational structure creates a unified body capable of powerful, coordinated action while protecting individual members from harm.

V. RESOURCE DEVELOPMENT AND

SUSTAINABILITY Achieving our vision requires substantial material resources, talent, and infrastructure. We approach resource development not as a technical administrative function but as a fundamental aspect of building sovereignty. Our approach rejects both the capitalist market logic of competition and the nonprofit industrial complex model of dependency on elite donors.

Financial Strategy

Our financial strategy rests on principles of self-reliance, transparency, and alignment with our values:
Diversified Revenue Streams Membership Dues: Scaled according to ability to pay, creating reliable core funding

Community Fundraising: Events, crowdfunding, and grassroots appeals building broad financial participation

Enterprise Income: Revenue from cooperative businesses and services supporting our mission

Strategic Partnerships: Resource-sharing with aligned organizations maximizing collective impact

Major Gifts: Contributions from wealth holders committed to our principles and directed by our priorities

This diversified approach prevents dependency on any single source while building financial participation across economic levels of our community. Resource Distribution and Governance Participatory budgeting processes involving membership in resource allocation decisions

Clear, transparent financial reporting available to all members

Democratic oversight through elected finance committees and independent auditors Regional equity ensuring resources reach communities regardless of wealth disparities

Emergency and opportunity funds enabling rapid response to crises and strategic openings Financial Systems and Infrastructure Banking and investment through Black-owned financial institutions and credit unions where possible

Multiple reserve funds: operating reserves, capital acquisition funds, and long-term sustainability endowment

Accounting systems meeting both legal requirements and management needs Financial literacy training enabling broad participation in economic decision-making Technology platforms facilitating efficient resource mobilization and allocation

Our financial strategy recognizes that how we raise, manage, and deploy resources must embody the values we seek to advance in society. We reject exploitative fundraising practices, dependency relationships with donors, and market-driven decision-making about resource allocation.

Talent Development and Human Resources

Our most valuable resource is our people - their skills, knowledge, commitment, and creativity. We invest in developing our members' capabilities while creating ethical, supportive working conditions for those employed by the organization: Leadership Development Pipeline Identifying emerging leaders through community organizing and chapter activities Mentorship pairings connecting experienced organizers with developing leaders

Specialized training developing both hard skills and soft leadership capabilities

Rotational opportunities exposing developing leaders to different organizational functions

Intentional succession planning ensuring continuity through leadership transitions

Staff and Organizer Support

Compensation reflecting living wages and family support needs Healthcare and benefits supporting physical and mental wellbeing

Workload management preventing burnout and sustainable long-term commitment Democratic workplace practices embodying our values in daily operations

Personal development supporting holistic growth beyond organizational roles Skills Mobilization and Knowledge Management

Skills inventory tracking capabilities available within our membership

Systems connecting those with specific expertise to relevant projects and needs

Knowledge capture preserving insights and lessons from our work Cross-training reducing dependency on individual knowledge holders Communities of practice fostering ongoing learning and improvement

Our approach to talent development recognizes that movements often underinvest in their people, leading to burnout, skills gaps, and unsustainable operations. We prioritize both developing new capabilities and sustaining existing ones, creating conditions where members can contribute for the long haul rather than sacrificing themselves for short-term gains.

Physical Infrastructure and Assets

Physical spaces and material resources provide essential foundations for our work: Community Centers and Gathering Spaces Multi-purpose facilities hosting meetings, classes, events, and daily community activities

Design reflecting our cultural values and meeting practical operational needs

Accessibility features ensuring participation regardless of disability or age

Security measures protecting our people and resources while remaining welcoming

Sustainability features reducing environmental impact and operational costs

Equipment and Technology Assets

Media production capabilities: audio, video, print, and digital

Transportation resources supporting mobility for organizing and service delivery
Communication tools facilitating coordination across geographic distances
Office and administrative equipment supporting organizational functions

Emergency response resources addressing community needs during crises

Land and Property Strategy

Strategic property acquisition in neighborhoods of historical and cultural significance

Mixed-use development combining organizational needs with community housing and enterprises

Legal structures protecting community ownership and preventing market speculation

Renovation and construction approaches prioritizing Black contractors and sustainable methods

Stewardship practices ensuring long-term maintenance and improvement of assets
Our infrastructure development recognizes that physical spaces shape organizational culture and operational capabilities.
We create environments that reflect our values - beautiful, functional, and rooted in our aesthetic traditions while meeting contemporary needs.

Sustainability Planning and Resilience

Sustainability requires planning beyond immediate operational needs to ensure long-term viability through changing conditions: Long-Term Financial Planning Five and ten-year financial projections guiding current decisions

Endowment development creating permanent support for core functions
Capital campaign strategies for major acquisitions and developments

Scenario planning preparing for economic downturns and opportunities Intergenerational wealth transfer strategies capturing community resources Organizational Resilience Measures Distributed leadership preventing dependency on individual charismatic figures Documentation of systems and processes ensuring operational continuity

Cross-training ensuring critical functions can continue despite personnel changes

Backup systems and redundancy for essential infrastructure Regular security assessments identifying and addressing vulnerabilities

Regenerative Practices

Environmental sustainability in all operations and facilities Work rhythms balancing intensity with rest and recovery Cultural practices celebrating victories and processing challenges

Integrating arts, ritual, and celebration sustaining spiritual dimensions of our work Conflict transformation approaches addressing tensions before they become disruptive

Our sustainability planning recognizes that movements often sacrifice long-term viability for short-term urgency. We balance immediate needs with infrastructure development, creating a movement built to last for generations. As the Leviathan remains a powerful presence regardless of passing storms, our movement maintains its integrity and purpose through changing political seasons. This comprehensive approach to resource development and sustainability ensures that our vision is matched with the material

means to achieve it. We build our capacity not by mimicking corporate or nonprofit models but by developing approaches aligned with our values and appropriate to our context.

VI. VISION OF THE FUTURE

What does victory look like? What world are we fighting to create? Our vision of the future guides our strategy and sustains our commitment through difficult struggles. We envision a transformed society where Black people enjoy full self-determination, dignity, and flourishing - not as an isolated enclave but as part of a broader liberation of humanity from systems of domination.

Political and Governance Transformation

In our vision of the future, Black communities exercise genuine

self-governance through institutions of our own design. Political power is not abstract but concrete - expressed through decision-making authority over the conditions of our lives.

Local governance bodies - neighborhood councils, town assemblies, regional confederations - function through participatory democracy, with decisions made by those affected by them. These bodies control resources and infrastructure serving community needs. They are not symbolic advisory boards but sovereign entities with real authority.

Justice systems focus on healing harm and restoring community

bonds rather than punishment and control. Peace officers, selected from and accountable to the community, facilitate safety through de-escalation and mediation. Conflicts are addressed through restorative processes reflecting our cultural values of harmony and collective wellbeing. Our communities maintain diplomatic relations with other self-determining peoples - Indigenous nations, autonomous regions, liberated territories - creating networks of mutual recognition and support outside the framework of colonial nation-states. These relationships manifest through cultural exchange, economic cooperation, and political solidarity. Education systems are controlled by the community, with curriculum reflecting our histories, values, and aspirations. Schools serve as community anchors, with facilities available for multiple purposes beyond formal education. Learning happens across generations, with elders sharing wisdom and youth contributing new perspectives. This political vision is not separatism for its own sake but a practical recognition that self-determination requires institutional expression. Our governance structures embody the principle that those most impacted by decisions should make them, reversing the historical pattern of external control over Black communities.

Economic Transformation

In our vision, economic life is organized around meeting needs and enabling flourishing rather than profit maximization. Black communities control the resources necessary for dignified lives and exercise collective stewardship over land, water, and productive infrastructure. Cooperative enterprises serving community needs replace exploitative corporations. Worker-owners make decisions democratically, ensuring that technology serves human welfare rather than replacing labor. Automation reduces drudgery without creating unemployment, as productivity gains are shared through reduced working hours rather than workforce reduction. Land is held in community trusts, removing it from speculative markets and ensuring its use serves collective wellbeing. Housing is affordable, beautiful, and accessible, recognized as a right rather than a commodity. Mixed-use neighborhoods enable living, working, learning, and recreation without long commutes, reducing environmental impact while strengthening community bonds.

Local production meets many basic needs - food, clothing, household

items, building materials - supplemented by fair trade with other regions. This economic relocalization creates resilience against supply chain disruptions while reducing carbon emissions from transportation. Urban agriculture and regional farming networks ensure food sovereignty, with knowledge of growing and preparation widely shared. Financial institutions are community-controlled, deploying capital according to democratically determined priorities. Multiple forms of exchange - local currencies, time banking, gift economies - complement traditional monetary systems, creating flexibility and reducing dependency on external financial systems. This economic vision rejects both corporate capitalism and state bureaucracy, instead creating democratic economic institutions

accountable to communities. It recognizes that material conditions form the foundation for other dimensions of liberation.

Cultural and Spiritual Renewal

In our vision, cultural expression flourishes free from commercial exploitation or external definition. Black cultural production - art, music, literature, film, design - reflects our experiences, histories, and aspirations, created primarily for our communities rather than external markets. African and diasporic spiritual traditions are revitalized and practiced openly, their wisdom informing both personal development and collective decision-making. Multiple spiritual paths coexist respectfully, recognizing diverse approaches to connecting with ancestral wisdom, divine presence, and natural forces. Healing traditions addressing physical, mental, emotional, and spiritual wellbeing are integrated into community life. Healthcare combines scientific knowledge with traditional practices, emphasizing prevention and holistic wellness. Practitioners come from the community and remain accountable to it, ensuring that healing practices reflect cultural values. Intergenerational knowledge transfer ensures continuity of cultural wisdom while allowing innovation. Elders are respected for their experience while youth are valued for their fresh perspectives. Cultural institutions - museums, theaters, studios, gardens - provide spaces for both preservation and creation. Media and communications infrastructure is community-controlled, enabling narrative sovereignty. Our stories are told in our voices, without distortion or appropriation. Digital

technologies facilitate both local connection and global dialogue, allowing autonomous Black communities worldwide to share experiences and strategies. This cultural vision rejects both assimilation into dominant culture and

rigid traditionalism, instead creating space for cultural evolution rooted in our heritage but responsive to contemporary conditions.

Environmental Harmony and Regeneration

In our vision, Black communities enjoy healthy environments free from pollution, toxic facilities, and environmental hazards. The legacy of environmental racism is reversed through remediation of contaminated sites and restoration of natural systems. Infrastructure serves community needs while minimizing ecological impact. Renewable energy systems provide clean, affordable power controlled by the community. Water systems ensure safe drinking water while managing stormwater through green infrastructure. Waste is minimized through design, with remaining materials recycled or composted. Urban design prioritizes human scale, with walkable neighborhoods, abundant green space, and public gathering places. Transportation networks connect communities while minimizing pollution, with priority given to public transit, cycling, and pedestrian access over private vehicles. Food systems reconnect with ecological cycles, with regenerative agriculture rebuilding soil health, sequestering carbon, and supporting biodiversity. Agricultural practices draw from both African heritage farming techniques and contemporary sustainable innovations. Climate resilience infrastructure protects vulnerable communities from increasing impacts of global warming. Heat reduction strategies, flood protection, emergency shelters, and backup systems ensure that climate disasters don't reproduce historical patterns of racial inequity. This environmental vision recognizes both the disproportionate impact of ecological crises on Black communities and our role in creating regenerative alternatives. It rejects false choices between environmental health and economic wellbeing, instead demonstrating their interconnection.

Global Black Solidarity and Liberation

In our vision, Black people worldwide recognize our shared struggles while honoring our diverse cultures and contexts. Pan-

African solidarity manifests through mutual aid, knowledge exchange, resource sharing, and coordinated political action. Africa achieves genuine independence from neocolonial control, with nations determining their own development paths rather than following dictates of international financial institutions. Resource wealth benefits African populations rather than multinational corporations, funding infrastructure, education, and healthcare systems serving people's needs. Black populations throughout the diaspora establish forms of sovereignty appropriate to their contexts - from community control in predominantly Black cities to territorial autonomy in historically Black regions to dual citizenship arrangements between diaspora communities and African nations. Cultural exchange throughout the Black world strengthens our collective identity while celebrating our diversity. African cultural innovations inform diaspora communities while diaspora contributions influence African development. Languages, arts, spiritual practices, and knowledge systems flow across national boundaries, creating a vibrant global Black culture. International solidarity extends beyond the Black world to all peoples struggling against domination. Relationships with Indigenous nations, oppressed nationalities, workers' movements, and environmental justice initiatives create a global fabric of mutual support and shared vision. This international vision recognizes that Black liberation must be global to be complete. It rejects both narrow nationalism and abstract universalism, instead creating concrete solidarity based on shared interest in dismantling systems of domination.

The Path Forward

This vision is not utopian fantasy but the logical conclusion of our analysis and the practical direction of our strategy. Elements of this future already exist in embryonic form through the work of countless individuals and organizations building alternatives to current systems. Our task is to nurture these seeds while clearing the structures that prevent their growth. We recognize that transformation happens unevenly - victories in some areas while struggles continue in others. We celebrate advances without mistaking partial wins for complete liberation. We learn from setbacks without losing sight of our ultimate vision. The path to this future is not linear or predetermined. It will involve periods of rapid change and moments of apparent stagnation. It will require flexibility and creativity as conditions evolve. But throughout these twists and turns, our vision serves as a north star, guiding our movements toward the world we know is possible. Like the Leviathan, we move with purpose and power toward our destination. The future belongs to those with the courage to imagine it and the commitment to create it. That future - of sovereignty, dignity, and flourishing for Black people and all humanity - is the world the Black Dragons Initiative exists to build.

VII. CALL TO ACTION

The Black Dragons Initiative is both a vision and a vehicle - a means through which individuals and communities can act collectively to advance Black liberation. This manifesto is not merely for contemplation but for application. We call on you - whether reading as an individual, a community leader, or a representative of an organization - to join this movement for sovereign determination.

For Individuals

Your journey begins with personal commitment to this struggle. Individual actions, multiplied across our communities, create the foundation for collective power: 1. Educate Yourself and Others Study Black liberation history and theory through reading, discussions, and digital resources

Attend political education sessions organized by the Black Dragons Initiative or aligned groups

Share knowledge with family, friends, and colleagues, expanding awareness of our analysis Challenge misinformation and counternarratives that undermine Black liberation Apply critical analysis to media, politics, and social dynamics from a liberation perspective 2. Build Economic Self-Determination Redirect personal spending to Black-owned businesses and cooperative enterprises Develop personal skills contributing to community self-sufficiency

Join or help establish cooperative economic initiatives in your community Divest from exploitative corporations and financial

institutions

Support community land trusts and housing initiatives building collective ownership 3. Participate in Collective Action Join public demonstrations and direct actions advancing specific liberation objectives Participate in mutual aid networks addressing immediate community needs

[STRUCK 2026-09-11 - electoral candidate activity removed from this 501(c)(3)-hosted edition; parked for the affiliated 501(c)(4) sibling upon completion of its registration.]

~~Engage in electoral campaigns for candidates committed to community control.~~

Support campaigns targeting specific institutions or policies harming our communities

Contribute to rapid response mobilizations defending community members under threat 4. Contribute Resources Become a dues-paying member of the Black Dragons Initiative at a level matching your means

Volunteer time and skills toward specific organizational needs and campaigns Donate space, equipment, or materials supporting organizational operations

Share access to networks and platforms amplifying our message Contribute specialized expertise advancing particular aspects of our strategy 5. Embody Liberation Values Practice principles of cooperation, solidarity, and mutual respect in daily relationships

Address oppressive behaviors in personal interactions and community spaces Develop conflict resolution skills reducing dependency on state systems Share care responsibilities supporting community members with different needs

Celebrate cultural expressions reinforcing liberatory consciousness These individual actions form the cellular level of our movement - the building blocks from which larger structures grow. No action is too small when aligned with our strategic vision and principles.

For Communities and Local Leaders

Communities are the fundamental units of our movement - geographic neighborhoods, cultural groups, faith congregations, worker associations, and other existing collectivities with shared identity and relationships. If you hold formal or informal leadership positions within communities, we call on you to:

1. Convene Community Conversations Host discussion circles examining the Black Dragons Manifesto

Facilitate community assessment of local conditions and priorities Create strategic planning processes addressing specific local needs Organize regular assemblies for democratic decision-making

Establish communication channels keeping community members informed 2. Build Local Institutions Develop or strengthen community councils exercising self-governance Establish economic initiatives meeting local needs through cooperative models Create educational programs building skills and consciousness

Form safety and emergency response teams reducing dependency on state systems

Secure physical spaces for community activities and organizational operations 3. Mobilize for Collective Action Organize local participation in regional and national campaigns

Develop rapid response networks addressing immediate threats to community members

Create strategic direct action campaigns targeting specific local issues

[STRUCK 2026-09-11 - electoral candidate activity removed from this 501(c)(3)-hosted edition; parked for the affiliated 501(c)(4) sibling upon completion of its registration.]

~~Mobilize electoral power to advance candidates committed to community control.~~

Coordinate with other communities for synchronized actions increasing impact 4. Foster Leadership Development Identify and mentor emerging leaders, especially youth and those historically marginalized

Create leadership teams balancing different experiences, skills, and perspectives Implement training programs building organizing and governance capabilities Establish rotation systems preventing leadership entrenchment while ensuring continuity Connect local leaders with regional and national movement networks 5. Advance Sovereignty Projects Initiate or expand land acquisition through community land trusts Develop cooperative housing reducing vulnerability to displacement Create food sovereignty initiatives through urban agriculture and buying clubs

Establish community-controlled childcare, education, and elder support systems Build alternative justice processes addressing harm without police or prisons

Community-level organization provides the infrastructure through which individual action becomes collective power. By strengthening existing community formations and creating new ones where needed, we build the foundation for broader movement success.

For Allied Organizations and Institutions

Existing organizations and institutions - 501(c)(3) nonprofits, 501(c)(4) advocacy groups, academic institutions, faith organizations, businesses, professional associations, and others - can play crucial roles in advancing Black liberation when aligned with our principles and accountable to the communities they impact. If you represent such an entity, we call on you to: 1. Align Organizational Priorities Evaluate how current programs and strategies relate to Black sovereign determination

Shift resources toward initiatives advancing community control and self-sufficiency Implement decision-making processes ensuring accountability to impacted communities

Develop explicit commitments to Black liberation principles in mission and governance

Establish metrics measuring concrete contributions to

sovereignty objectives 2. Deploy Resources Strategically Direct funding toward Black-led initiatives building autonomous institutions

Provide in-kind support (space, equipment, technical assistance, etc.) to movement organizations

Leverage existing relationships and platforms to amplify liberation messages Share research, data, and analytical capabilities with movement strategists

Mobilize constituent networks for specific campaigns and actions 3. Transform Internal Practices Implement democratic governance models involving staff, constituents, and communities Develop hiring and advancement practices building Black leadership Establish compensation and benefit structures supporting dignified livelihoods

Create working conditions embodying liberation values rather than exploitative norms Implement learning practices enabling ongoing assessment and improvement 4. Build Strategic Alliances Join formal coalitions advancing specific aspects of the sovereignty agenda Establish resource-sharing agreements maximizing collective impact

Participate in coordinated campaigns targeting shared objectives Develop longer-term strategic partnerships with movement organizations

Connect organizations across sectors, creating broader networks of solidarity 5. Leverage Institutional Position Use existing relationships with funders, policymakers, and other institutions to advance liberation Challenge peers and partners to align with Black liberation principles and practices

Advocate for policy changes supporting community

control and self-determination

Redirect contracts and vendor relationships toward Black-owned enterprises Stand publicly with movement organizations during moments of intensified struggle

Aligned organizations and institutions provide specialized capacities, resources, and access points that complement grassroots organizing. When these entities authentically support sovereignty rather than co-opting or controlling community movements, they become valuable allies in the liberation struggle.

Joining the Black Dragons Initiative

Beyond these general calls to action, we invite direct participation in the Black Dragons Initiative itself. This begins by connecting with existing chapters or forming new ones: 1. Find Your Local Chapter Visit [\[blackdragonsinitiative.org\]](https://blackdragonsinitiative.org)

Attend an orientation session introducing our principles, strategy, and structure

Meet with chapter members to discuss how your skills and interests align with current priorities Begin participation in chapter activities, from study groups to direct actions

Complete the membership process, becoming a formal part of the organization 2. Form a New Chapter If no chapter exists in your area, gather at least five individuals committed to our principles

Contact the regional organizing committee to express interest in chapter formation

Begin the chapter development process: study circle -> organizing committee -> provisional chapter

Implement foundational activities establishing presence in your community Build toward full chapter status through meeting organizational benchmarks 3. Connect With Regional and National Structures Participate in regional assemblies connecting chapters across geographic areas

Engage with working groups focusing on specific aspects

of our strategic framework

Attend national congresses shaping organizational direction and strategy

Run for elected positions within governance structures when ready Contribute to cross-regional initiatives and campaigns

Whether through a local chapter, community formation, allied organization, or individual commitment, your participation strengthens our collective capacity to achieve liberation. Like the joined scales of Leviathan, each contribution becomes part of a unified whole greater than the sum of its parts. The time for action is now. The conditions that necessitate our movement grow more urgent by the day - displacement accelerates, surveillance intensifies, ecological crises deepen, economic exploitation continues. Yet the possibilities for transformation also expand through technological tools, shifting consciousness, and lessons learned from ongoing struggles. Join us in building the world we deserve - a world where Black communities control the decisions that affect our lives, where our children grow in safety and dignity, where our elders receive respect and care, where our cultural expressions flourish without exploitation, where our relationship with land and nature is regenerative rather than extractive. The Black Dragons Initiative stands ready to channel your energy, skills, and commitment into strategic action advancing our collective liberation. Together, we form the Leviathan - powerful, fearless, and unified in our determination to achieve sovereignty not merely in theory but in lived reality. The future belongs to those who organize for it. Let us organize, together, now. Power to the people. Black power. Black freedom.

BLACK DRAGONS INITIATIVE